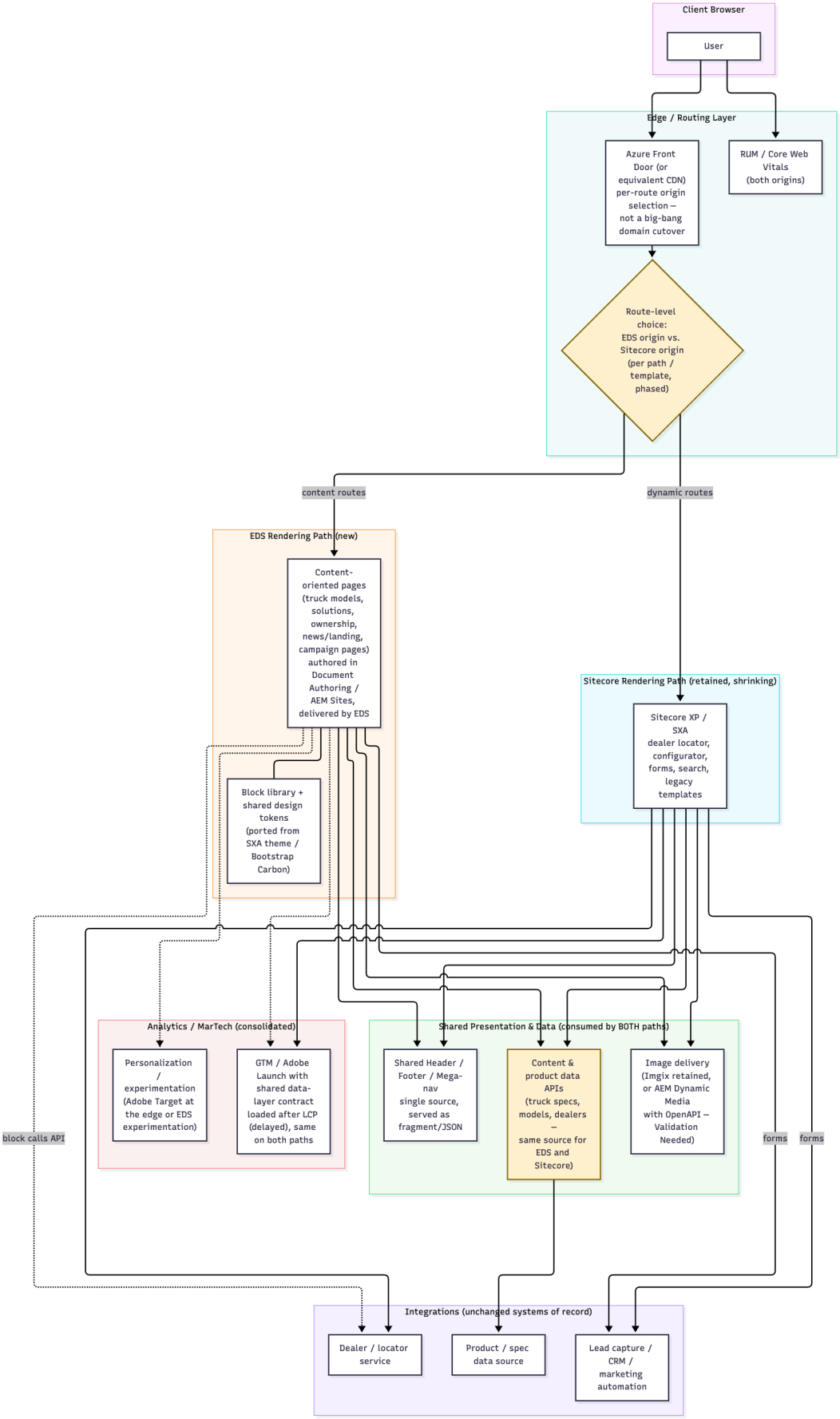
International Trucks (Navistar) — Future State Web Architecture (Proposed)

Companion to `current-state-architecture.md`. This is a directional target architecture, not a committed roadmap — every component marked "Validation Needed" requires a proof of concept or technical spike before it can be treated as a decision. Drafted 2026-10-17.

*Framing note: International's public site is a content-heavy Sitecore XP/SXA monolith with no sign of an entrenched headless investment. That makes a **progressive, route-by-route migration** the right shape: Edge Delivery Services (EDS) takes over content-oriented pages first, while Sitecore keeps serving the dynamic/transactional routes until each one is deliberately replaced or retained. Nothing here requires a big-bang cutover, and no decision is made about the Sitecore-backed integrations (dealer locator, configurator, forms) until they are inspected.*

Diagram



This diagram deliberately does **not** say which pages move first beyond the content-vs-dynamic principle. The routing split is per path or template and is decided during discovery.

What Changes vs. Current State

Target Component	Replaces / Evolves	Rationale	Validation Needed	Proof Point Needed
EDS for content-oriented pages	Sitecore server-rendered pages (`no-cache, no-store` HTML, ~240 KB homepage)	Static, edge-cached delivery with near-perfect Lighthouse scores; removes origin rendering from the critical path for the highest-traffic marketing pages	Confirm the content model (truck models, features, specs) can be expressed as EDS blocks/spreadsheets or AEM Sites content fragments; confirm authors can work in DA or Universal Editor	Migrate 3-5 representative pages (home, a truck model page, a solutions page, a news page) and compare Lighthouse/CWV vs. current
Edge-level routing (EDS vs. Sitecore)	One origin (Sitecore) behind Azure Front Door for all paths	Enables phased migration with instant rollback per route and keeps dynamic features working untouched	Confirm Azure Front Door rules (or an edge worker) can route by path with no URL change; confirm cookies/session on dynamic paths are unaffected	Route one path prefix (e.g. `/trucks/`) to EDS while the rest stays on Sitecore; verify SEO, canonicals, sitemap and analytics parity
Shared header / footer / nav	Header/footer rendered by SXA renderings per site, and separately maintained on sister properties	One source of truth across EDS, Sitecore and (optionally) sister sites such as parts, fleet and used trucks	Confirm nav source (Sitecore content tree today) can be exported as JSON/HTML fragment and consumed by an EDS block and a Sitecore rendering	Build the nav as a fragment service; render it in an EDS block and in a Sitecore page on a test path
Content & product data layer	Data embedded in Sitecore items and SXA components	Truck specs/model data surfaced identically to both paths; avoids authoring twice during the transition	Identify authoritative sources for specs, models, trim levels and dealer data; confirm API availability and licensing	One EDS block and one Sitecore rendering reading the same spec endpoint
Tag/MarTech consolidation	Two GTM containers loading ~15 vendors in the page head/body	Reduces main-thread cost; one data-layer contract across both paths; opportunity to delay non-critical tags	Inventory tags with owners; confirm which are still in use (e.g. duplicate heatmaps: Hotjar and Clarity)	Move non-critical vendors behind a post-LCP/consent trigger on the EDS path and compare INP/TBT
Personalization & experimentation	Sitecore xDB/personalization	Edge-based personalization and A/B testing without origin rendering	Confirm whether xDB personalization rules are actually in use; define the audiences worth preserving	Run one experiment (e.g. hero variant) on an EDS page and compare to Sitecore baseline
Image delivery	Imgix (47 references on the homepage)	Imgix works fine with EDS; may be kept to limit migration scope	Decide whether to keep Imgix or move to AEM Dynamic Media with OpenAPI / EDS native image optimization	Render the same hero in both and compare weight/LCP
Modern front-end baseline	jQuery 3.4.1, React 16 from CDN, Bootstrap 5 Carbon	Removes end-of-life libraries from migrated pages; ships vanilla JS blocks	Inventory which Sitecore widgets depend on jQuery/React 16 and must remain until retired	Confirm migrated pages ship no jQuery/React
Security posture	CSP with `'unsafe-inline'` and `'unsafe-eval'`	A tighter CSP becomes feasible on EDS pages once inline tag scripts are reduced	Confirm tag vendors can run under a nonce/hash-based policy	Deploy a report-only strict CSP on the EDS path

> **Highlighted rows in the diagram (Routing, Data layer) need discussion.** They are the least validated and highest-impact items.

Sequencing Notes (draft, for discussion)

1. **Discovery spike (1-2 weeks):** inventory Sitecore templates, traffic by path, authoring workflows, and the integrations behind the dealer locator, configurator and forms. This decides the content-vs-dynamic split.
2. **Pilot migration:** 3-5 high-traffic content pages on EDS (with the shared header/footer), served from a staging path, with Lighthouse/CWV comparison against production Sitecore.
3. **Edge routing pilot:** route one path prefix to EDS in production behind Azure Front Door; validate SEO (canonicals, sitemap, redirects), analytics parity and rollback.
4. **Shared nav and data layer:** stand up the header/footer fragment and a spec/model API so both origins consume them; this can run in parallel with step 3.
5. **MarTech consolidation:** tag inventory and delayed loading on the EDS path; evaluate consolidation of the two GTM containers.
6. **Scale-out:** migrate remaining content templates in waves; retire Sitecore templates only when traffic on them reaches zero. Decide per dynamic feature whether to rebuild as an EDS block or leave on Sitecore.

Explicit Non-Goals / Open for Debate

- This document does **not** claim Sitecore is retired. Dynamic features stay on Sitecore until each one is inspected and a replacement is justified.
- This document does **not** specify which sister property (parts, fleet, used trucks, Mexico, store) joins the shared header/footer or EDS; that is a later decision.
- This document does **not** prescribe the authoring tool (Document Authoring vs. AEM Sites with Universal Editor); it depends on author profile and governance needs.
- Backend systems of record (dealer, CRM, spec data, commerce for the store) are assumed unchanged.